



The Humanitas Institute

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Augustine School

School Website: <https://augustineschool.com/>

December 21, 2025

Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS Member School

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools ACCS or the Society for Classical Learning SCL is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Classicality Audit: Augustine School (Jackson, TN)

Website audited: <https://www.augustineschool.com>

Executive Summary

Overall classification: CLASSICAL

Why: Augustine School's public materials repeatedly foreground a Classical Christian identity oriented to truth, goodness, and beauty; formation in wisdom and virtue; and explicitly Christian theological grounding. The site highlights communal prayer and faith practices, and it engages parents through recurring on-campus events. While the website could present more explicit curricular language (Trivium, Latin, Great Books) and pedagogy (Socratic seminars) to improve coverage evidence, the existing signals and ACCS accreditation substantively support a classical designation.

Top signals found on site: - "Discover the Good, the True, and the Beautiful ... Classical Christian Education"; "wise and virtuous" formation; "Biblically-Based" and "Gospel-Centered" framing; "Lordship of Christ" (homepage)

- Season of Prayer; community prayer emphasis - ACCS accreditation announcement clearly asserting a "true classical Christian education" framework - Parental/community engagement: recurring Mommy & Me on-campus events; Open House; Christmas/Spring Recitation events

Six-category results (see full details below): - Religious & Metaphysical Foundations: CLASSICAL - Purpose & Goal: CLASSICAL - Curriculum: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL (coverage light on explicit Trivium/Latin/Great Books terms) - Pedagogy: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL (clear recitation/memory work; less explicit on Socratic/seminar) - Faculty: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL (signals present, but limited explicit "portrait of a teacher/mentor" language) - Parents & Community: CLASSICAL

Reference framework used: Six Essential Elements of a Classical School keyword indicators (positive/negative) and lexicon (e.g., truth, goodness, beauty, virtue, theology, liturgy, Trivium, Great Books, Socratic, schol  , wonder, chanting, project-based/experiential)

CATEGORY 1: RELIGIOUS AND METAPHYSICAL FOUNDATIONS

Mandatory keyword analysis 1) School keywords found: - Transcendentals and formation: "Good, the True, and the Beautiful"; "wise and virtuous" - Grounded in theology: "Biblically-Based"; "Gospel-Centered"; "Lordship of Christ" - Liturgical/communal practices: "Season of Prayer"; thanksgiving to God in accreditation news; community prayer invitation

2) Comparison to Six Elements lexicon:

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- Positive indicators matched: truth/goodness/beauty; virtue/wisdom; theology/Christ-centered; communal prayer/worship signals (liturgy/chapel analogs)
 - Negative indicators: none found.

3) Quantitative estimate:

- Positive hits: 10; Negative hits: 0 → 100% positive
- Coverage estimate: 0.95 (all three sub-areas—transcendentals, theology, communal worship—are evidenced)

Rating: CLASSICAL

CATEGORY 2: SCHOOL PURPOSE AND GOAL

Mandatory keyword analysis 1) School keywords found: - Purpose/ends: “form students who love goodness, truth, and beauty” and become “wise and virtuous” - Formation emphasis: “partner with families to develop a student’s intellect, character, and faith”; “lifelong love of learning” - Pragmatic signals present but secondary: “100% College Acceptance Rate,” CLT rankings (measurable outcomes)

2) Comparison to Six Elements lexicon:

- Positive: formation, virtue, wisdom, pursuit of the true/good/beautiful
- Negative: mentions of college placement/testing are potential negatives if primary; here they appear as outcomes, not the telos

3) Quantitative estimate:

- Positive hits: 7; Negative hits: 2 → 78% positive
- Coverage estimate: 0.85

Rating: CLASSICAL

CATEGORY 3: SCHOOL CURRICULUM

Mandatory keyword analysis 1) School keywords found: - Classical identity, humanities sensibility: “Classically-Informed,” “classical model of education,” “excellent literature,” “finest art” - ACCS accreditation (strong signal of a classical curriculum implementation) - Recitation events (curricular culture touchpoint)

2) Comparison to Six Elements lexicon:

- Positive sought: explicit Trivium/Quadrivium; “grammar, logic, rhetoric”; Great Books/primary sources; Latin/Greek; “history” (vs “social studies”)
- What’s missing on public pages: explicit mentions of “Trivium,” “Latin,” “Great Books,” “Socratic” in curriculum description. No negative signals (e.g., “social studies” as a label, STEM-first, project-based dominance) surfaced.

3) Quantitative estimate:

- Positive hits: 4; Negative hits: 0 → 100% positive among found terms
- Coverage estimate: 0.40 (explicit curricular language is sparse on the site pages crawled)

Rating: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

CATEGORY 4: SCHOOL PEDAGOGY (Teaching Methods)

Mandatory keyword analysis 1) School keywords found: - Memory/recitation culture: "Autumn Recitation," "Christmas Recitation" (events), choir/music pages show singing as a norm
- Contemplative/communal prayer moments (schoolwide prayer guide) suggest space for rest/Scholé-like contemplation, though "Scholé" is not named

2) Comparison to Six Elements lexicon:

- Positive: memorization/recitation; singing; communal rhythms; contemplative posture
- Missing/less explicit: "Socratic seminar," rhetoric speeches/theses, explicit "Scholé" terminology.

3) Quantitative estimate:

- Positive hits: 2; Negative hits: 0 → 100% positive among found terms
- Coverage estimate: 0.50 (lower school signals are clear; upper school Socratic/rhetoric evidence is light in the public pages)

Rating: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

CATEGORY 5: FACULTY

Mandatory keyword analysis 1) School keywords found: - "Engaging faculty ... form students who love goodness, truth, and beauty" (faculty as formative/living curriculum vibe) - ACCS accreditation piece thanks "wonderful teachers and administration," signaling teacher quality and alignment with classical aims

2) Comparison to Six Elements lexicon:

- Positive sought: teacher as mentor/model of virtue; collegial faculty; "portrait of a teacher" statements
- Evidence is present but brief on the public site; no negative signals found.

3) Quantitative estimate:

- Positive hits: 2; Negative hits: 0 → 100% positive among found terms
- Coverage estimate: 0.35 (limited explicit teacher philosophy profiles on the site)

Rating: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

CATEGORY 6: PARENTS AND COMMUNITY

Mandatory keyword analysis 1) School keywords found: - "Partner with families" language on homepage (parent partnership) - Regular on campus events for families (Mommy & Me series; Open House), indicating welcome/formation touchpoints

- Community prayer initiative (Season of Prayer)

2) Comparison to Six Elements lexicon:

- Positive: partnership with parents; parent/community engagement; intentional community events
- Negative: none surfaced.

3) Quantitative estimate:

- Positive hits: 4; Negative hits: 0 → 100% positive
- Coverage estimate: 0.80

Rating: CLASSICAL

Overall Assessment

Based on the keyword analysis mapped against the Six Elements framework, Augustine School merits a CLASSICAL rating. Its public materials clearly communicate classical Christian identity and aims (truth, goodness, beauty; wisdom and virtue), theological grounding, prayerful communal life, and robust parent partnership. Website presentation would be strengthened by explicitly naming Trivium/Quadrivium, Latin/Great Books, and upper□school Socratic/rhetoric practices, but the existing signals—and ACCS accreditation—justify the overall classical classification.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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